

theme and user interface elements for Windows Vista.” The new sounds were collaboration between Robert Fripp, Tucker Martine, and Steve Ball, and aimed to leverage the visual cues of the Aero interface through audio: “Just like the visual cues of the new Start button, the audio cues of the new sounds are ‘rounded’ and ‘translucent.’”



Start menu-search

4.2 The New Start Menu

That “rounded” and “translucent” extend to all the aspects of the new interface. The most visible element to have undergone this change is the new Start button that leads the Vista taskbar. The button no longer carries the “Start” label: it is now spherical and glass-like in appearance, and is fittingly referred to as the “Orb” or the “Pearl.” Clicking on the Orb reveals the second major change to the taskbar—the Start Menu has been completely overhauled with a much greater emphasis on searching for the program or document you’re looking for. This change is not always welcome: instead of being able to launch applications directly from the Start Menu by typing out their first letters, the typing now triggers a search. This process is usually a second or two slower than the previous method of launching applications. This also implies that hot-buttons are no longer valid for the Start Menu. For example, while you could highlight the My Documents folder under Windows XP by pressing and releasing the Windows key and then [D] on your keyboard; the same process will trigger a